

Rentbuddy

Het idee is om een app te maken waar buitenlandse studenten alle informatie kunnen vinden die nodig is voor het huren van een kamer/appartement/whatever in Den Haag. De app kan contracten vertalen, en heeft alle informatie over onderhuren.

Met base44 maken we de web-app.

API: the Contract Helper currently sends your text to a backend endpoint (/api/analyse-contract) that doesn't exist yet in this app — so every analysis falls back to the clearly labelled demo result. There are two ways to make it real: I can connect it to the platform's built-in AI directly inside the app (no external server needed — recommended, and I can set it up in one go), or, if your project requires your own Python backend, just give me its URL once it's hosted and I'll point the app at it. Which would you like?

We first used Base44 to create the design and structure of the RentBuddy web app. We gave Base44 a detailed prompt explaining the target audience, the pages we needed and how the Contract Helper should work. We then copied the generated code into Visual Studio Code and used it to create a separate working version of the website.

Originally, the Contract Helper in Base44 was supposed to send the contract to a Python backend, but we could not get this connection to work properly. Because the assignment required us to make a real API call from Python, we decided to set up the connection ourselves outside Base44. With help from ChatGPT, we corrected and updated the code so that it worked with the newest version of the Gemini API. The Python code now sends the rental contract and instructions to Gemini, receives the AI-generated analysis and returns the result for the user.

Eerste prompt:

Build a responsive web application called “RentBuddy” for international students searching for and renting housing in The Hague, Netherlands.

Purpose

RentBuddy helps international students overcome language and information barriers in the Dutch rental market. Housing information is currently spread across different websites, rental contracts are usually written in difficult Dutch, and international students may not understand subletting rules, registration requirements, deposits, service costs or their basic rights.

The app supports SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities by giving international students equal access to understandable and reliable housing information.

This is an informational tool, not a housing marketplace, law firm or replacement for professional legal advice. Do not generate fake housing listings or claim to show live availability.

Target audience

International students aged approximately 18–30 who are looking for a room, studio or apartment in The Hague and may not understand the Dutch rental system or Dutch legal terminology.

Use English as the default interface language. Include a visible language selector with several more common languages.

The selected language should apply to the interface and AI-generated contract explanation.

Visual style

Create a friendly, modern and trustworthy student-focused design.

Use:

- A warm dark-blue primary colour
- Light blue and soft beige backgrounds
- Coral or orange as an accent colour
- Rounded cards and buttons
- Simple housing and document icons
- Generous white space
- Clear and accessible typography
- A friendly illustrated logo featuring a small house and the name RentBuddy

The design should feel helpful and welcoming, not corporate or overly formal.

Make the application responsive for desktop and mobile. Meet basic accessibility standards with good contrast, readable text, labels on form fields, keyboard-friendly interactions and clear error messages.

Navigation

Create a top navigation bar with:

- Home
- Find Housing
- Rental Guide
- Contract Helper
- Subletting
- Get Help
- Language selector

On mobile, use a hamburger menu.

1. Home page

Create a welcoming hero section.

Headline:

“Renting in The Hague, made easier.”

Supporting text:

“Understand rental contracts, explore trusted housing resources and learn the rules before you rent or sublet.”

Primary button:

“Check a rental contract”

Secondary button:

“Explore the housing guide”

Under the hero, add three feature cards:

Understand your contract

Translate and explain difficult Dutch rental contracts in clear language.

Find the right resources

Discover useful housing websites and organisations for students in The Hague.

Know the rules

Learn about registration, deposits, service costs, tenant rights and subletting.

Add a short section explaining why RentBuddy exists:

“Finding housing is already difficult. Understanding another country’s rental system should not make it harder. RentBuddy brings essential information together and explains it in language international students can understand.”

Add a visible disclaimer:

“RentBuddy provides general information and AI-generated explanations. It does not provide legal advice. Always verify important information with an official organisation.”

2. Find Housing page

This page should help users understand where and how to search. It must not pretend to display live housing availability.

Start with a short questionnaire:

- What are you looking for?
 - Room
 - Studio
 - Apartment
 - Short-stay housing
- What is your maximum monthly budget?
- When do you need housing?
- How long do you need it?
- Do you need registration at the address?
- Are you a student at THUAS, Leiden University, Inholland or another institution?

After submission, show a personalised housing-search plan with:

- Suitable types of housing
- Relevant categories of websites to check
- Recommended search terms
- Documents the student should prepare
- Important warnings based on their situation
- A reminder to confirm whether municipal registration is allowed

Create a section called “Where to search” with curated resource cards. Each card must clearly state that availability is not checked by RentBuddy.

Include categories such as:

- Student housing providers
- General rental platforms
- University housing resources
- Room and sublet platforms
- Municipality and official information

Each card should have:

- Organisation or platform name
- Short description
- Type of housing
- Possible fees or waiting-list warning
- External-link button
- “Official source” label where applicable

Do not invent exact prices, waiting times or availability.

Add a “Before you respond to a listing” checklist:

- Check whether registration is allowed

- Never send money before verifying the landlord and property
- Ask what is included in the rent
- Check the deposit
- Request a written contract
- Be careful when the price appears unusually low
- Verify the address and identity of the landlord or agency

3. Rental Guide page

Create an easy-to-scan guide using cards or expandable accordion sections.

Include:

- Types of housing
- Registration at the municipality
- Basic rent and service costs
- Deposits
- Fixed and indefinite rental contracts
- Notice periods
- Viewing a property
- Documents landlords may request
- Tenant responsibilities
- Landlord responsibilities
- Housing permits
- Rent allowance
- Red flags and possible scams
- What to check before signing
- What to check when moving in

Use simple English and explain Dutch terms when relevant.

Create a “Dutch housing words” glossary with terms such as:

- Huurcontract
- Kale huur
- Servicekosten
- Borg
- Inschrijving
- Huisvestingsvergunning
- Huurtoeslag
- Onderhuur
- Opzegtermijn
- Huurcommissie

Each word should have a short, plain-language explanation.

4. AI Contract Helper page

This is the main AI feature.

Add a clear introduction:

“Upload or paste a Dutch rental contract. RentBuddy will translate and explain the most important parts in your selected language.”

Allow the user to:

- Upload a PDF or TXT file
- Paste contract text manually
- Select the explanation language
- Confirm that personal information has been removed where possible
- Click “Analyse my contract”

Before submission, show a privacy warning:

“Rental contracts can contain names, addresses, signatures, bank details and identification information. Remove unnecessary personal information before uploading.”

Prepare this page to connect to a separate Python API endpoint:

POST /api/analyse-contract

The frontend should send:

- Extracted contract text
- Selected language
- A request ID

The frontend should never expose an API key. Show loading, success and error states.

For the current prototype, create a clearly labelled demo response when the backend is unavailable. Do not silently present placeholder information as a real AI analysis.

The AI analysis result should contain these sections:

Contract overview

- Type of contract
- Start date
- End date, if present
- Monthly basic rent
- Service costs
- Total monthly payment
- Deposit
- Notice period

Important conditions

- Is registration mentioned?
- Is subletting allowed?
- Are pets allowed?
- Are additional fees mentioned?
- Who is responsible for repairs?
- Are house rules mentioned?

Clauses to review carefully

Show unclear, unusual or potentially important clauses. Do not automatically label a clause illegal. Use wording such as:

“This clause may require additional clarification.”

Questions to ask before signing

Generate practical questions the student can ask the landlord or housing provider.

Missing information

Clearly list important information that could not be found in the uploaded text.

Translation and difficult terms

Translate important sections and explain difficult Dutch housing terminology.

Confidence and source references

For every finding, display the relevant quotation or section from the uploaded contract when possible. If the AI cannot determine something, show:

“Not clearly stated in the contract.”

Always display:

“This AI explanation may contain mistakes and is not legal advice. For important decisions, contact an official housing or legal-support organisation.”

Add buttons for:

- Copy explanation
- Download summary
- Start a new check
- Find official help

Do not store uploaded contracts permanently in the frontend.

5. Subletting page

Create a step-by-step subletting guide specifically for international students in The Hague.

Explain:

- What subletting means
- The difference between being a tenant, main tenant and subtenant
- Why permission from the landlord may be necessary
- Why the main rental contract must be checked
- Registration at the address
- Temporary absence and studying abroad
- Written subletting agreements
- Rent, deposits and service costs
- What can happen when subletting is not permitted
- Where to ask for official help

Add an interactive “Can I sublet?” information checker.

Ask:

1. Are you the main tenant?
2. Do you rent an independent home or only a room?
3. Does your contract mention subletting?
4. Do you have written permission from the landlord?
5. Will you return to the property?
6. Does the subtenant need registration?

After submission, provide a cautious explanation and a personalised checklist.

Never give a definitive legal conclusion. Use wording such as:

“Based on your answers, you may need written permission before subletting. Check your contract and contact your landlord or an official support organisation.”

Add a downloadable subletting preparation checklist.

6. Get Help page

Create cards for trusted support categories:

- Municipality of The Hague
- Huurcommissie
- Juridisch Loket
- University housing office
- Student support services
- Tenant-support organisations
- Emergency or scam reporting

Each card should explain:

- What the organisation can help with
- When the student should contact it
- Link to the official website

Only use verified official links. If an exact link is not available, create a clearly marked placeholder for the development team to verify. Never invent an organisation, telephone number or email address.

Add a contact-route selector:

“What do you need help with?”

Options:

- I think a listing may be a scam
- I do not understand my contract
- I have a conflict with my landlord
- I need help with registration
- I have a question about my rent
- I want to sublet my room
- I am at risk of losing my housing

Based on the selection, display the most appropriate type of organisation to contact.

Safety and AI behaviour

The AI must:

- Use only the submitted contract text when analysing a contract
- Never invent missing clauses
- Clearly distinguish between what the contract states and general information
- Say when information cannot be found
- Avoid definitive legal conclusions
- Never tell users that a contract is legally valid or invalid
- Never guarantee that a listing or landlord is trustworthy
- Encourage users to verify important decisions with an official source
- Treat uploaded documents as sensitive information
- Avoid storing personal data unnecessarily

Technical requirements

Build the frontend in React with clean, reusable components.

Prepare integration with a Python backend using the endpoint:

`POST /api/analyse-contract`

Expected request:

```
{
  "contract_text": "The extracted text of the rental contract",
  "output_language": "English",
  "request_id": "unique-request-id"
}
```

Expected response structure:

```
{
  "overview": {
    "contract_type": "",
    "start_date": "",
    "end_date": "",
    "basic_rent": "",
    "service_costs": "",
    "total_payment": "",
    "deposit": "",
    "notice_period": ""
  },
  "conditions": [],
  "clauses_to_review": [],
  "questions_to_ask": [],
  "missing_information": [],
  "translated_terms": [],
  "source_references": [],
  "warning": ""
}
```

Add graceful error handling for:

- Empty text
- Unsupported file type
- File too large
- Unreadable PDF
- API unavailable
- Invalid API response
- Text that does not appear to be a rental contract
- Contract written in an unsupported language

Use sample data only where needed for demonstration and label it clearly as demo content.

Do not add login, payment, chat, saved contracts or a database in the first version. Focus on a clear and usable hackathon MVP.